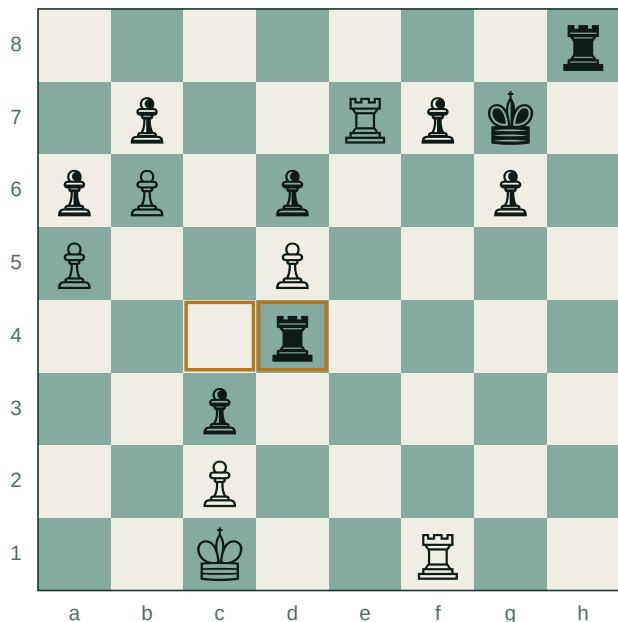


Skewers: White, move 39

Skewers

White to move



Previous move: 38...Rxd4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

39. Rxf7+ Kh6 40. Rh1+ Kg5 41. Rxh8

39.Rxf7+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on f7. Recorded reply: **39...Kh6**.

40.Rh1+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **40...Kg5**.

41.Rxh8 The rook captures the rook on h8.

At the end, nominal material is White 14 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -2 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The defender may block, capture the attacker, or protect the rear piece while moving the front one. Alignment alone is not enough.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A skewer puts the more important target in front. When that target moves, a piece behind it may be lost. Checks make the geometry especially forcing.

HOW TO LOOK

Search ranks, files, and diagonals where two enemy pieces line up. Calculate the first target's legal responses.

The defending king is on g7. Absolute pin: pawn on f7.